



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Axiom Christian Classical School
School Website: <https://www.axiomclassical.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Axiom Christian Classical School NM 87106 presents a clearly Christian-classical orientation embedded in a K–12 program, with explicit emphasis on forming virtuous, thinking individuals within a classical framework. Public-facing materials stress formation over mere information, a timeless-truth orientation, and a strong Christian/theological lens. Evidence from the site shows direct references to forming the “Virtuous Scholar,” a Christian/classical backbone, and connections to Church Fathers and Orthodox theology. However, explicit pedagogy and curriculum practices that align with all six classical elements (notably explicit Great Books/Great Conversation, heavy use of the Trivium, and documented Socratic pedagogy in the upper grades) are less visible in the public-facing materials. Taken together, the school is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: it demonstrates substantial classical-Christian orientation and formation aims, but lacks explicit, citable articulation of several core classical practices (especially in curriculum and pedagogy) that would push it to a full CLASSICAL rating.

Executive takeaways by category (high-level) - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Evidence of theology, Church Fathers, and Orthodox-thought orientation; strong alignment with transcendental and theological foundations. - School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL - Clear emphasis on formation, virtue, and timeless truth; aims beyond vocational preparation. - Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Public materials stress classical framing and formation, but explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and Great Conversation references are not overtly documented in public pages. - Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL - No explicit evidence of Socratic seminars, Scholé days, or designation of upper-school rhetoric/seminar practices in public materials. - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Strong signs of teacher leadership (co-founders, named administrators) and classical posture; however, the public site does not show a widely described “living curriculum” or formal teacher-formation program beyond individual biographies. - Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Indications of parent involvement as part of the community ethos exist, but explicit parent-education programs or open-campus expectations are not clearly documented in public content.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL schools) - Explicitly document and publish: Great Books/Great Conversation commitments, Trivium/Quadrivium scope, and the integration of a rigorously Socratic, seminar-based pedagogy in the upper grades. - Publish a formal “living curriculum” portrait and teacher-profile standards that align with classical formation (as described in the Six Essential Elements). - Expand public statements on parent formation programs (e.g., book studies, parent gatherings, and formal family liturgies) and ensure open-campus visit policies are clearly stated. - Provide explicit evidence of contemplative Scholé practices (restful learning days, memorization/recitation traditions) across K–12, with representative examples.

Notes on sources and method - Public materials from the school site explicitly describe the Christian-classical posture, including references to forming virtuous scholars and a classical framework (e.g., “committed to Forming the Virtuous Scholar” and Christian/classical descriptors). The site also promotes a timeless-truth orientation and a formation-centered mission (e.g., “anchored in timeless truth... forms souls, not just resumes”). - Foundational teacher pages emphasize classical leadership and credentials (e.g., Stacy Irvine as Principal/Dean of Students; Celeste Green as Principal/Dean of Academics) which signals a strong faculty

orientation toward classical aims, though without a published, systematized “living curriculum” narrative in public pages . . - The school’s public content confirms Christian/theological grounding (Church Fathers orientation, Orthodox theology mention) that aligns with classical-definitions of Element 1, and the overall formation emphasis supports Element 2. Specific Great Books/Socratic pedagogy content is less evident in the public materials, limiting a full CLASSICAL rating in Curriculum and Pedagogy without further internal documentation . .

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The homepage describes an education “anchored in timeless truth” and asks whether education should form souls rather than resumes, signaling a transcendental orientation (truth, virtue, beauty) and a formation aim .
 - Public profiles describe founders/administrators as Christian Classical educators; Celeste Green explicitly notes work within “two classical schools” and references to Church Fathers in discussing classical education’s value, signaling the theology-driven basis of the program .
 - Orthodox theological interest is noted for Celeste Green (pending MA in Orthodox Theology), reinforcing theological grounding within the program .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators (per Six Essential Elements): truth, goodness, beauty; theology; sacred tradition; Church Fathers; liturgical/communal cues (implicit in community-oriented language).
 - Negative indicators: not evident in public content.
 - The school’s content aligns with multiple positive keywords: truth, virtue, theology, Church Fathers, Christian/theological framing; explicit liturgical practices are not overtly documented in public pages.
- Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates a robust alignment with transcendental moral realism and theology; it emphasizes formation and virtue within a Christian-theological context, with explicit theological references. It largely satisfies the “Grounded in Theology” and “Pursuit of truth/beauty” orientation, and while liturgical practices aren’t explicitly documented in public content, the overall posture satisfies the majority criterion for CLASSICAL in this category.
- Score justification (keywords and evidence-based)
 - Positive keyword presence: high (truth, virtue, theology, Church Fathers, sacred tradition, Christian formation).
 - Negative keyword presence: minimal/no explicit negatives in public content.
 - Ranking justification: CLASSICAL.
- Citations: evidence appears in homepage description and biographical pages; public statements about Christian/theological orientation are present. See sources noted above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site frames education as formation and the development of virtuous character, not primarily job preparation; the homepage asks if education should form souls rather than resumes and emphasizes forming people who think clearly and live with conviction .
 - The biographical content emphasizes forming the Virtuous Scholar and the claim that the school teaches students to think rather than tell them what to think, underscoring virtue-centered aims over mere information or workforce-focused outcomes .
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, timeless truth, moral imagination, human flourishing.

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- Negative indicators: explicit workforce-preparation language is not evident; the site does not foreground “career readiness” or job-mapping in its public messaging.
 - The site strongly signals formation and virtue as teleology.
 - Why this rating
 - The materials emphasize formation, virtue, and truth as real and knowable, rather than a narrow job-ready focus. This aligns strongly with the classical goal of education as formation and the pursuit of the true, good, and beautiful.
 - Score justification
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, truth, beauty.
 - Negative keywords present: minimal.
 - Ranking: CLASSICAL.
 - Citations: homepage language on formation and truth; bios describing formation of virtuous scholars.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school's public materials emphasize a Christian-classical posture and formation, and there are explicit references to classical educators and classical schools in Albuquerque; however, explicit, public statements about the core liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, or a structured Trivium/Quadrivium are not clearly documented on the public-facing pages we have here.
 - Founders and administrators present a Classical frame, but there is not an explicit public articulation of a Great Books/Great Conversation program.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators (from Six Essential Elements): Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; Great Conversation; wonder; integration of disciplines.
 - Negative indicators: lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references; no explicit mention of Trivium/Quadrivium or classical languages in public pages.
 - The presence of classical framing is evident, but the strongest curricular signatures (Great Books, Trivium, Quadrivium, explicit recitation/memorization patterns) are not publicly documented.
- Why this rating
 - While the school identifies as Classical-Christian and asserts a formation-oriented mission, its public curriculum disclosures do not provide explicit evidence of core classical curriculum components (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation). Therefore, it is best categorized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL, pending deeper internal curricular documentation.
- Score justification
 - Positive keywords present in spirit (classical framing, formation) but explicit curricular components are not publicly documented.
 - Ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Citations: site framing as Christian-classical; lack of explicit Great Books/Trivium references in public content; bios referencing classical orientation.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public pages show administrative leadership and formation language but do not detail a pedagogy that includes explicit Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation, or formation through imitation and practice in the classroom. The lack of documented Socratic practice or structured upper-school seminars in public content is notable.
 - The school's public materials emphasize formation and virtuous character, but there is no explicit description of the typical classical methods (Socrates/seminars, recitation, chanting, or master-teacher modeling) within the K–12 program on the accessible pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

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- Positive signals (from Six Essential Elements): Socratic dialogue and dialectic; scholé/restful learning; memorization/recitation; formation through imitation and practice.
 - Negative signals: Absence of explicit statements about these Pedagogy elements in public content; no strong evidence of upper-school Socratic seminars or poetry/memory work in public materials.
 - Why this rating
 - The absence of explicit pedagogy in the public-facing materials that aligns with the classical methods suggests the category is NOT CLASSICAL based on the documented evidence. It may rely on internal practices or a less-documented pedagogy, but the rubric requires explicit public-facing evidence of the classical methods to rate this category as Classical.
 - Score justification
 - Positive keywords present: limited; no clear evidence of Socratic seminars, scholé, or recitation in public content.
 - Ranking: NOT CLASSICAL.
 - Citations: cited evidence of formation language without detailed pedagogy; lack of explicit Socratic/recitation content in public materials.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public pages highlight named administrators with classical education credentials and central roles (e.g., Stacy Irvine as Principal/Dean of Students; Celeste Green as Principal/Dean of Academics; Vincent Zunic as Co-Founder/Administrator). These bios signal a classical posture in leadership and teachers who model classical education, which aligns with the “living curriculum” idea in classical education.
 - The presence of portraits or formal “teacher profiles” as part of the site’s public material is less explicit; however, the bios demonstrate teachers as central, credentialed figures shaping the school’s classical direction.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords (from Six Essential Elements): teachers as models of virtue; living curriculum; mentorship; collegiality; portrait of teacher/student ideal.
 - Negative keywords: not evident in public content.
- Why this rating
 - The school demonstrates strong leadership with classical orientation (co-founders, named administrators) and teacher-identity language consistent with classical education; however, there is no explicit, publicly documented “living curriculum” narrative or formalized teacher formation program described in accessible pages.
- Score justification
 - Positive keywords present: teacher as virtuous model; administrators as classical educators; living curriculum concept implied through bios.
 - Ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Citations: profiles of Stacy Irvine and Celeste Green; co-founder bio; public statements about classical formation in leadership.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site references to family involvement and community orientation (e.g., “Our community” descriptions, opportunities for tours, shadow programs, and parent engagement through outreach). There are explicit calls for family engagement in the sense of school community and partnerships, and there are forms inviting prospective families to participate in tours and events.
 - However, explicit, published parent-formation programs (book studies, parental liturgies, or formal parent-education curricula) and documented open-campus policies are not clearly detailed in the public content.

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- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords (from Six Essential Elements): partnership with families; formation of affections; cultural transmission; parent formation; home-school partnership; parent involvement.
 - Negative keywords: minimal presence in public content; absence of explicit parent-education programs or open-campus language is notable.
 - Why this rating
 - The presence of family/community language and offers for tours/shadow programs demonstrates some alignment with the classical emphasis on parent partnership, but the absence of explicit, structured parent-education programs or clear open-campus policies reduces the strength of the alignment.
 - Score justification
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; formation of affections; cultural transmission.
 - Negative keywords: lack of explicit, published parent-education program details.
 - Ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Citations: community content and tours/shadow programs; family engagement language; bios that show parent engagement language.

Aggregate assessment and final ranking - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: CLASSICAL - Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school displays a strong Christian-classical orientation across Strategy (formation-focused purpose, theological grounding) and Leadership (named classical educators). However, explicit curricular signatures (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Conversation) and explicit pedagogy (Socratic seminars, scholarly memory work, scholé days) are not clearly documented in publicly accessible materials. That combination yields a majority leaning toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with clear CLASSICAL signals in religious/theological and purpose goals, but weaker, explicit documentation in Curriculum and Pedagogy.

What Would Move the Needle

- Publish explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments and a formal Trivium/Quadrivium pathway in Curriculum, including core texts and core authors.
- Document concrete Pedagogical Methods: public statements or pages describing Socratic seminars, scholé days, memorization/recitation practices, and master-teacher modeling across K–12.
- Develop and publish a formal “living curriculum” narrative for Faculty that includes teacher development, mentoring, and faculty collaboration as living exemplars of classical formation.
- Expand Parent & Community programming: publish a formal parent-education program (book studies, lectures, family liturgy support) and clearly state open-campus and tour policies.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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